PROJECT 1

Threat Intelligence Brief

Research a real-world threat actor and document your findings like a professional analyst

Your Name:	Date:	Threat Actor Chosen:
TYLER AREND	26/08/2026	ANONYMOUS

What is this project?

Real security analysts write Threat Intelligence Briefs to help their team understand who might attack them and how.

In this project, you will research ONE real-world threat actor (a hacker group or nation-state attacker) and fill out this document with your findings. You will use free, public sources like Wikipedia, MITRE ATT&CK, and news articles. When you are done, you will have a real artifact to add to your professional portfolio!

Step 1: Choose Your Threat Actor

Pick ONE from the list below, or ask your instructor for a different one. Circle or highlight your choice.

Nation-State Groups	Financially Motivated	Hacktivists
• APT28 (Fancy Bear) • APT29 (Cozy Bear) • Lazarus Group • APT1 (Comment Crew)	• REvil / Sodinokibi • DarkSide • Carbanak • FIN7	• Anonymous • Killnet • Lapsus$ • LulzSec

Where to research (all free!):

MITRE ATT&CK: https://attack.mitre.org/groups/ (search your threat actor by name)
Wikipedia: Search the group name
Google News: Search '[group name] cyberattack'
Cybersecurity blogs: CrowdStrike, Mandiant, Recorded Future all have free public reports

Step 2: Complete the Threat Actor Profile

Part A: Basic Identity

Official Name / Also Known As	Country or Region of Origin
Anonymous / Anon	*International; United States, the United Kingdom, Australia, the Netherlands, South Africa, Spain, India, and Turkey*

Estimated First Active	Type of Threat Actor
2003 or 2008	*Hacktivists*

Part B: Motivation

What does this group WANT? Why do they attack? Check all that apply and add a note:

[ ] Financial gain (steal money/data to sell) [✔] Espionage (steal government/military secrets) [✔] Disruption (break things, cause chaos) [✔] Political / Ideological beliefs	[ ] Revenge or retaliation [ ] Blackmail / Ransomware [ ] Warfare / Nation-state goals [ ] Other: _____

In your own words, explain WHY this group does what they do:
As a decentralized group of hackers, Anonymous typically engages in two primary types of activity: entertainment and political activism. In entertainment, Trent Peacock stated during a 2008 interview with Search Engine, a radio station, their motivation is "we are doing it for the lulz." In political activism, the group targets governments, organizations, and corporations that they accuse of internet censorship or internet surveillance. They also participate in anarchist, anti-government, and anti-capitalist activism.

Part C: Attack Methods

What techniques does this group use? Use MITRE ATT&CK to find these.

Primary Attack Vector(s)
DoS / DDoS, botnets, SQL injections

Notable Malware or Tools Used
GigaLoader, JMeter, Low Orbit Ion Cannon (LOIC)

Typical Target Industries	Geographic Focus
Government, corporations, and agencies	*Global, United States of America*

Part D: Notable Attack - A Real Example

Find ONE real-world attack this group is known for and describe it below.

Name of the Incident / Attack
Project Chanology (2008)

What Happened? (Write 3-5 sentences in your own words)
In 2008, the Church of Scientology issued a cease-and-desist against the gossip blog Gawker after the blog posted a video of Tom Cruise praising the religion. As a result, users on 4chan began prank-calling the church, sending black faxes, and launching DDoS attacks against their websites. By using tools such as Gigaloader, JMeter, and LOIC, these 4chan users were able to flood the servers with TCP and UDP packets. As a part of the attack, users recorded and uploaded a YouTube video, addressing the leaders of the Church of Scientology, which gained hundreds of thousands of views over 10 days. The popularity of this video and their attack led to a global protest of the Church of Scientology across 43 countries and created the collective hacktivist group “Anonymous”.

Which part of the CIA Triad was most affected?	What could have been done to prevent it?
Availability	*Monitoring, training, and increased server resources*

Step 3: Assess the Threat Actor

Sophistication Level

Based on your research, rate this threat actor using the scale below:

1	2	3	4	5	**Your Rating:** 3 / 5
1 = Script Kiddie	*2 = Low skill*	*3 = Moderate*	*4 = Advanced*	*5 = Nation-state APT*	*Moderate*

Why did you give this rating? Explain your reasoning.

Over the nearly 20 years of Anonymous' involvement in hacktivism, and with the continually changing membership of the group, the overall threat level of this threat actor is moderate. While the group has facilitated attacks against government websites and news broadcasts, they have also participated in lower level attacks against groups such as the Ku Klux Klan. In this attack, as well as a few others, the information they claimed to obtain from these hacks was later proven incorrect. With the varying membership comes varying skill levels, resulting in a few dozen arrests since the creation of the group.

Step 4: Reflection

What was the most surprising thing you learned?

I'm surprised by how well-received the group is by the general public, as well as how quickly the group was able to grow, seemingly by random chance. Several internet and cybersecurity experts have been interviewed and quoted saying they were fans of the group and what it stands for. Other hackers or hacker groups have also expressed their inspiration from Anonymous; many hacker groups have been created as off-shoots of Anonymous, including LulzSec and AntiSec.

What Security+ exam topic did this threat actor make you think about most?

Social Engineering. Most of this group's power comes from their size and social media presence. In 2012, TIME magazine named Anonymous in their top 100 Most Influential People in the World.

Step 5: List Your Sources

Write down where you found your information. At least 2 sources required.

#	URL or Name of Source	What info did you find here?
1	Anonymous (Hacker Group)	Basic Identity, Motivation, and Attack Methods
2	What is Hacktivism? | CrowdStrike	Attack Methods
3	Anonymous - 2012 TIME 100: The Most Influential People in the World - TIME	Social Engineering example

Before You Submit: Checklist

Check each box when complete:

- [ ] I filled in my name, date, and chosen threat actor at the top
- [ ] I completed all sections (Basic Identity, Motivation, Attack Methods, Notable Attack)
- [ ] I gave a sophistication rating and explained why
- [ ] I wrote a reflection (at least 2-3 sentences total)
- [ ] I listed at least 2 sources
- [ ] I read through my work and it makes sense to me

Portfolio tip: Save this as a PDF and upload it to your GitHub or LinkedIn profile. Title it: 'Threat Intelligence Brief - [Threat Actor Name] - [Your Name]'